

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla
Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankar Aiyar
Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai
Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta, Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra
Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta, HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon
Photo Editor: Bandeep Singh
Art Editor: Sapna Kapoor
Associate Editors: Bhavna Vij-Aurora, S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan, AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar, CHANDIGARH: Ramesh Vinayak, LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra
Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen
Special Correspondents: Shaif Rahman, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar, BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran
Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish; BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra, MUMBAI: Jhilmil Motihar, Aditi Pat; PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava
Copy Desk: Nardeep Singh Dahiya (Senior Editor), Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar, Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shilpi, Priyanka Sood, Shweta Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav
Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbent Negi, Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh, AHMEDABAD: Shalish Rayal, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar, MUMBAI: Mandaar Deodhar, Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul, Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)
Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh
Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji, Vandana Nayyar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rasmi Ajmani Girdhar, Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur
Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production), Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry
Associate Publisher: Manoj Sharma (Impact)

IMPACT TEAM

Senior General Manager: Upendra Wellington (West and South)
General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram (Chennai), Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lad (West)
Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha,
Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director
D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager
Vinod Des, General Manager (Sales)
Deepak Bhatt, General Manager, Sales (North)
Rajesh Menon, General Manager, Sales (West)
M. Krishna Kiran, Deputy General Manager, Sales (South)
S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIV Number 5; For the week
Jan 27-Feb 2, 2009, released on Jan 26

• Editorial Office: Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001. Phone: 23315801-4; Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi
• Subscriptions: For circulation contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301. Phone: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (91)201 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078060; e-mail: irc@indiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-2444423-6; Fax: 24444358 • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Connaught House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place, New Delhi • Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 • Impact Office: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor, Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Panel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 • Hamilton House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330 • 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, 2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phone: 26478525-41; Telex: 041-6177 Into In; Fax: 26472178; Cable: Livmedia Chennai • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phone: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore • 52, Jawaharal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phone: 22825396; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata • 6-3-8857/78, Sonajagda, Hyderabad-500062; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411496; Fax: 23403484 • 39/045, Karakoram Road, Kochi 682016; Phone: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059 • 24C, "Suryashilp Bhag", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchsheel, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana); A-9, Industrial Complex, Mangalmal Nagar, district Kaushalpur-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Balapur Road, Alandi, Near Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra). Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.
• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@indiatoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in

From the editor-in-chief

Now that all the ceremony is concluded and the real work has begun, Barack Obama has an enormous and most unenviable job to do. His first priority will be to reverse the rapidly worsening meltdown of his country's economy. Overseas, he will be acting to end the war in Iraq and destroying Al Qaeda in Afghanistan as he had promised in his election campaign. His actions in both these areas will have important repercussions on India.

In the last decade, the world's two biggest democracies have moved closer to each other than at any moment in their history. George W. Bush backed and pushed a path-breaking Indo-US nuclear deal in the last year of his presidency. The United States remains one of our largest trading partners and now we even carry out joint defence exercises. How America deals with Pakistan continues to affect us directly as Mumbai's 26/11 has so rudely shown.

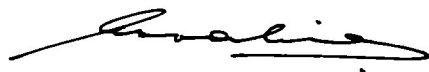
This change of guard in America is of huge significance to us. In the present case, it is not only a change of the man at the top but also of a party with very different foreign policy goals from the previous administration. American presidents of the past have conducted diplomacy on a highly personal basis. In this context, there is no reason to believe that Obama will be any different. If India is to progress in its relationship with the United States and ensure we don't lose the gains we have made, we must understand Obama and his team well. It is fortunate that Hillary Clinton, generally regarded as sympathetic towards India, is his choice as secretary of state.

Our cover story this week is about the likely impact of the Obama presidency on India. The story seeks to answer several important questions around the new man in charge at the White House. How different will he be from George W. Bush? How will he handle India's confrontation with Pakistan over terrorism and the issue of Kashmir? What shape will the nuclear deal take under the Obama presidency? Will his tenure strengthen mutual relations between the two nations and also between two economies which can only benefit through closer co-operation?

The cover story was put together by Managing Editor Raj Chengappa who in three decades of journalism has analysed and written about three separate American presidents. Our in-house expert on strategic affairs and Indo-US relations Chengappa says, "India must remember, it cannot bring old baggage to the table when dealing with this new President who believes in big change." Change, then—in approach, strategy and thinking—seems to be the order of the day in the Obama era.

In his powerful inaugural address after he was sworn in as the 44th US President, Obama had a message for the world. He said: "We cannot help but believe that the old hatreds shall someday pass; that the lines of tribe shall soon dissolve; that as the world grows smaller, our common humanity shall reveal itself; and that America must play its role in ushering in a new era of peace."

Let us hope for all of us that Barack Obama lives up to that promise.


(Aroon Purie)



OUR NOVEMBER
2008 COVER